ST MARY'S DSG, KLOOF

GRADE: 10 **2025**

ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE
MACBETH
LITERATURE ESSAY TOPICS

TIME: 60 MINUTES+ 5 MINS READING TIME

EXAMINER: C DYER **MARKS: 30**
MODERATORS: ENGLISH TEACHERS

Instructions:

1. Answer either Question 1 or Question 2. Indicate your choice clearly.
2. Rule a margin down the right hand side of each page and do not write in the margins.
3. Your response must be in the form of a well structured literary essay.
4. Your essay should be approximately 500 words in length.
5. Close and relevant reference to the text in the question is essential.
6. Do NOT provide a word count at the end of your essay.

Take note:
You are encouraged to give your own judgments. Attempt to create space in which your voice can be evident. The examiners will judge your answers on your understanding of, and insight into, the given text and will assess the competence with which your answers are expressed.

QUESTION 1

villain

(in a film, novel, or play)
A character whose evil actions or motives are important to the plot.

victim

A person harmed, injured, or killed as a result of a crime, accident, or other event.
A person who is tricked or duped.
A person who has come to feel helpless and passive in the face of misfortune or ill-treatment.
Consider the above definitions.

1. Analyse whether you believe Lady Macbeth is the villain, or victim, of this story.

OR

QUESTION 2

"Often, a tragic hero's fall from grace is triggered by one decision that sends them tumbling down to their inevitable fate. One choice leads to another and before long, it is too late to turn back."

-Clara Smith

The character of Macbeth is an example of a Shakespearean tragic hero. Discuss the truthfulness of this statement. Your discussion should refer to the character of Macbeth and the events which occur in the play, *Macbeth*.